

****ICSE CLASS 10 HISTORY & CIVICS — COMPLETE REVISION NOTES****

****CHAPTER 1: THE FIRST WAR OF INDEPENDENCE, 1857****

****YouTube Lecture:**** <https://youtu.be/e8AZQ7mla84?si=rU6OUtyZ9E9EKZo>

****1. Causes of the Revolt of 1857****

****A. Political Causes****

The British policy of expansion through the Doctrine of Lapse (Lord Dalhousie) annexed many Indian states like Satara, Jhansi, and Nagpur. When a ruler died without a natural male heir, the state was taken over by the British. This created fear and resentment among Indian rulers. The annexation of Awadh on grounds of misgovernment in 1856 further angered Indians.

****B. Social and Religious Causes****

The British introduced reforms like the abolition of Sati (1829), the Widow Remarriage Act (1856), and allowed Christian missionaries to propagate their religion. Indians feared that the British intended to destroy their religion and convert them to Christianity. Laws such as the Religious Disabilities Act (1850), which allowed converts to inherit ancestral property, deepened these fears.

****C. Economic Causes****

The economic policies of the British ruined Indian agriculture and traditional handicrafts. Heavy taxation on peasants led to poverty and famines. The import of cheap machine-made goods from Britain destroyed the Indian textile industry. Many artisans and weavers lost their livelihood. Landlords (zamindars) who could not pay heavy land revenue lost their estates. All sections of society were economically distressed.

****D. Military Causes****

Indian sepoy in the British army were poorly paid, had limited opportunities for promotion, and were often treated with contempt. A major cause of discontent was the introduction of the new Enfield rifle. The cartridges were greased with fat of cows and pigs, and the sepoy had to bite off the cartridge before loading. This hurt both Hindu and Muslim religious sentiments. The immediate spark was the refusal of Mangal Pandey in Barrackpore to use the greased cartridge.

****2. Consequences of the Revolt****

****A. End of Company's Rule (Queen Victoria's Proclamation)****

The British government took over the administration of India from the East India Company. The Government of India Act 1858 was passed. Queen Victoria's Proclamation on 1 November

1858 promised to respect the rights, dignity, and honour of Indian princes, and assured Indians that there would be no interference in their religious matters.

****B. Changes in the Army****

The British reorganised the army to prevent any future uprising. The proportion of British soldiers was increased. The artillery and important military posts were reserved for the British. Sepoys from regions that participated in the revolt, like Awadh and Central India, were recruited in smaller numbers, while recruitment was increased from the loyal regions of Punjab and Nepal (Gurkhas).

****C. Relation with Princely States****

The policy of annexation was completely abandoned. The Doctrine of Lapse was withdrawn. Indian princes were assured that their territories would not be annexed in the future. The princely states were made dependent on the British Crown and were encouraged to remain loyal.

****IMPORTANT QUESTIONS: THE FIRST WAR OF INDEPENDENCE, 1857****

****Q1.**** Explain any three political causes that led to the Revolt of 1857.

****Q2.**** How did the social and religious policies of the British contribute to the outbreak of 1857?

****Q3.**** What was the Doctrine of Lapse? Name any two states annexed under this policy.

****Q4.**** How did the economic exploitation by the British alienate the Indian masses before 1857?

****Q5.**** Explain the immediate (military) cause that sparked the Revolt of 1857.

****Q6.**** State any three consequences of the First War of Independence, 1857.

****Q7.**** What promises were made to the Indians in Queen Victoria's Proclamation of 1858?

****Q8.**** How was the British army reorganised after the Revolt of 1857?

****Q9.**** What changes were introduced in the British policy towards the Indian Princely States after 1857?

****Q10.**** Write a short note on the economic causes of the Revolt of 1857.

****CHAPTER 2: GROWTH OF NATIONALISM****

****YouTube Lecture:**** <https://youtu.be/gTjfRlcc8AQ?si=2qjti7KdiKG4oQm8>

****1. Factors Leading to the Growth of Nationalism****

****A. Economic Exploitation****

The British systematically drained India's wealth. Raw materials were taken to Britain, and finished goods were sold back at high prices. Indian handicrafts and cottage industries were ruined. Heavy land revenue made peasants poor. Famines became frequent. Indians realised that their poverty was a direct result of British colonial exploitation. Dadabhai Naoroji propounded the "Drain Theory" to explain this transfer of wealth from India to England.

****B. Repressive Colonial Policies****

Discontent against British rule grew due to various repressive policies. The Vernacular Press Act (1878) and the Arms Act (1878) were passed during Lord Lytton's time. The Vernacular Press Act curtailed the freedom of the Indian language press. The Arms Act disallowed Indians from keeping arms without a licence. The Ilbert Bill controversy (1883) exposed the racial discrimination of the British. The maximum age for the ICS examination was reduced, making it difficult for Indians to enter the civil service. These policies made Indians feel humiliated.

****C. Socio-Religious Reform Movements****

Reform movements revived pride in India's rich past culture and heritage. They worked for the removal of social evils like caste discrimination, sati, and child marriage. They promoted women's education and widow remarriage.

****Raja Rammohan Roy:**** Called the "Father of Indian Renaissance". He fought against Sati and got it abolished in 1829. Founded the Brahmo Samaj in 1828. He advocated for women's rights, freedom of the press, and Western education.

****Jyotiba Phule:**** A social reformer from Maharashtra who fought against caste oppression. He founded the Satyashodhak Samaj in 1873 to promote social equality. He worked for the education of women and lower castes.

****Swami Dayananda Saraswathi:**** Founded the Arya Samaj in 1875. He gave the call "Back to the Vedas". He preached against idol worship, caste system, and child marriage. He promoted education and widow remarriage.

****Swami Vivekananda:**** Chief disciple of Sri Ramakrishna Paramahansa. He represented Hinduism at the World Parliament of Religions in Chicago in 1893. His speeches instilled a sense of pride in Indian culture and spirituality. He emphasised service to mankind and preached the oneness of all religions.

****D. Role of the Press****

Indian newspapers played a crucial role in awakening national consciousness. They exposed the injustices of British rule and spread the message of nationalism. Important newspapers included Amrit Bazar Patrika (Sisir Kumar Ghosh), Kesari and Maratha (Bal Gangadhar Tilak), and The Hindu (G. Subramania Iyer). The press made people politically aware and united them across regions.

****2. Foundation of the Indian National Congress****

The Indian National Congress was founded in 1885 by a retired British civil servant, Allan Octavian Hume. The first session was held in Bombay (Mumbai) in December 1885 under the presidentship of Womesh Chandra Bonnerjee. It was attended by 72 delegates. The second session (1886) was held in Calcutta (Kolkata) under the presidentship of Dadabhai Naoroji.

****Immediate Objectives of the Congress:****

To promote a sense of national unity and brotherhood among Indians from all parts of the country.

To place the grievances of Indians before the British government in a constitutional and peaceful manner.

To demand reforms in the administration and for the Indianisation of higher services.

To discuss and make the public aware of the major problems facing the country.

****IMPORTANT QUESTIONS: GROWTH OF NATIONALISM****

****Q1.**** Explain how economic exploitation by the British contributed to the growth of Indian nationalism.

****Q2.**** Mention any two repressive policies of the British that led to national awakening in India.

****Q3.**** State any two contributions of the following reformers:

- (a) Raja Rammohan Roy
- (b) Jyotiba Phule
- (c) Swami Dayananda Saraswathi
- (d) Swami Vivekananda

****Q4.**** How did the Indian press contribute to the growth of nationalism?

****Q5.**** Who founded the Indian National Congress and in which year? Where was its first session held?

****Q6.**** State the immediate objectives of the Indian National Congress when it was founded.

****Q7.**** Who was the president of the first session of the Indian National Congress?

****Q8.**** Explain how the Vernacular Press Act and Arms Act created discontent among Indians.

****CHAPTER 3: INDIAN NATIONAL CONGRESS – OBJECTIVES AND EARLY PHASE****

****YouTube Lecture:**** <https://youtu.be/f1-vxNd36Rg?si=WgmwEKMbAKFao07N>

****1. The Early Nationalists (Moderates) — 1885 to 1907****

****A. Objectives and Methods of Struggle****

The Early Nationalists had faith in the British sense of justice and fairness. They believed that the British would grant necessary reforms if the just demands of Indians were placed before them. Their methods were constitutional, peaceful, and within the law. They organised meetings, sent petitions and memorials to the British government, and passed resolutions in Congress sessions. Their main aim was self-government within the British Empire, like the Dominions of Canada and Australia.

****B. Contributions of Key Leaders****

****Dadabhai Naoroji:**** Known as the "Grand Old Man of India". He was the first Indian to be elected to the House of Commons in Britain (1892). He propounded the "Drain Theory" to explain how British colonial rule drained India's wealth. He served as President of the Indian National Congress three times (1886, 1893, 1906). His book "Poverty and Un-British Rule in India" exposed the economic exploitation of India.

****Surendranath Banerjee:**** Called the "Indian Burke". He founded the Indian Association (1876) in Bengal, which was a precursor to the Indian National Congress. He campaigned against the Vernacular Press Act, the Arms Act, and the reduction of the ICS examination age limit. He was a gifted orator and journalist who inspired national awakening.

****Gopal Krishna Gokhale:**** Regarded as the political guru of Mahatma Gandhi. He founded the Servants of India Society (1905) to train national workers. He was a moderate leader who pleaded for greater Indian representation in the administration. He wanted reforms through dialogue and peaceful means.

****2. The Assertive Nationalists (Radicals) — 1905 to 1916****

****A. Causes of the Partition of Bengal and its Impact****

The Partition of Bengal was announced by Lord Curzon in July 1905 and came into effect on 16 October 1905. The official reason given was administrative convenience. However, the real motive was to divide the Bengali-speaking people and weaken the nationalist movement by creating a division between Hindus and Muslims. The British planned to create East Bengal and Assam with a Muslim majority, leaving West Bengal with a Hindu majority. The partition was met

with widespread protests. The Anti-Partition Movement (Swadeshi and Boycott) was launched, which transformed the nature of the freedom struggle.

****B. The Surat Split of 1907****

The differences between the Early Nationalists (Moderates) and Assertive Nationalists (Radicals) came to a head at the Congress session in Surat in 1907. The Moderates wanted to confine the Swadeshi and Boycott movement only to Bengal and continue with constitutional agitation. The Radicals wanted to extend it to all parts of India and adopt the policy of passive resistance and non-cooperation. The split occurred on the issue of the Presidentship of the session. Dr. Rash Behari Ghosh (a Moderate) was elected President, which the Radicals protested. The Radicals were driven out of the Congress, and the Moderates took control of the organisation.

****C. Objectives and Methods of the Assertive Nationalists****

The Assertive Nationalists had no faith in British justice. Their objective was complete Swaraj (self-government), not just Dominion status. They believed in mass agitation, swadeshi, boycott, national education, and passive resistance. They wanted to involve the common masses in the freedom struggle.

****D. Contributions of Key Leaders****

****Bal Gangadhar Tilak:**** Known as "Lokamanya". The most prominent leader of the Radicals. Through his newspapers Kesari (Marathi) and Maratha (English), he awakened political consciousness. He famously declared, "Swaraj is my birthright and I shall have it." He popularised the Ganapati and Shivaji festivals to unite people. He started the Home Rule League in 1916.

****Bipin Chandra Pal:**** Known as the "Father of Revolutionary Thought in India". He was a brilliant orator and journalist. He advocated for swadeshi, boycott, and national education. He preached nationalism through his speeches and writings and toured different parts of India spreading the message.

****Lala Lajpat Rai:**** Known as "Punjab Kesari" (Lion of Punjab). He was a fearless leader who opposed the Simon Commission in 1928 with the slogan "Simon Go Back!" During the protest, he was injured in a lathi charge by the police under James A. Scott and later died. He wrote extensively on nationalism and actively participated in the Swadeshi Movement.

****3. The Muslim League (1906)****

The Muslim League was founded on 30 December 1906 at Dacca (Dhaka) under the leadership of Aga Khan, Nawab Salimullah of Dacca, and Nawab Mohsin-ul-Mulk. Factors leading to its formation included the British policy of "Divide and Rule", which encouraged communal separatism. The success of the Indian National Congress alarmed some Muslim leaders who felt the need for their own political platform to safeguard Muslim interests. Its objectives included promoting loyalty to the British government, protecting the political rights of Muslims, and presenting Muslim interests before the government.

****4. The Lucknow Pact (1916)****

The Lucknow Pact was a historic agreement between the Indian National Congress (represented by Bal Gangadhar Tilak) and the Muslim League (represented by Muhammad Ali Jinnah). It was signed at the Lucknow session of the Congress in 1916. Both parties agreed to work together to press for constitutional reforms from the British government. The Congress accepted the Muslim League's demand for separate electorates for Muslims. This pact marked an important step towards Hindu-Muslim unity in the freedom struggle.

****IMPORTANT QUESTIONS: INDIAN NATIONAL CONGRESS – OBJECTIVES AND EARLY PHASE****

****Q1.**** Explain the methods used by the Early Nationalists (Moderates) in their struggle for political reforms.

****Q2.**** State any two contributions each of Dadabhai Naoroji, Surendranath Banerjee, and Gopal Krishna Gokhale.

****Q3.**** Why was Bengal partitioned in 1905? What was the real motive behind it?

****Q4.**** How did the Anti-Partition Movement (Swadeshi and Boycott) influence the national movement?

****Q5.**** What were the causes and results of the Surat Split of 1907?

****Q6.**** State two differences between the methods of the Early Nationalists and the Assertive Nationalists.

****Q7.**** State any two contributions each of Bal Gangadhar Tilak, Bipin Chandra Pal, and Lala Lajpat Rai.

****Q8.**** When and where was the Muslim League founded? What were its objectives?

****Q9.**** What was the Lucknow Pact (1916)? Why was it significant?

****Q10.**** Who made the declaration "Swaraj is my birthright and I shall have it"? Name the newspapers through which he spread national ideas.

****CHAPTER 4: MAHATMA GANDHI AND THE NATIONAL MOVEMENT (NON-COOPERATION MOVEMENT)****

****YouTube Lecture:**** <https://youtu.be/rHQkh80MZfK?si=8Btu8OMHneEU3GHH>

****1. Causes of the Non-Cooperation Movement (1920-1922)****

****A. The Khilafat Movement****

After the First World War, the British imposed harsh terms on defeated Turkey and the position of the Khalifa (the religious head of Sunni Muslims) was threatened. Indian Muslims, led by the Ali Brothers (Mohammad Ali and Shaukat Ali), Maulana Abul Kalam Azad, and others, started the Khilafat Movement to pressure the British. Mahatma Gandhi saw this as an opportunity to unite Hindus and Muslims and linked the Khilafat Movement with the national movement.

****B. The Rowlatt Act (1919)****

The Rowlatt Act gave the British government sweeping powers to arrest and detain any person without trial for up to two years. It applied even in peacetime and severely curtailed civil liberties. Indians called it the "Black Act". Gandhi started a nationwide Satyagraha against the Act. Hartals and protests broke out across India.

****C. The Jallianwala Bagh Massacre (April 13, 1919)****

On 13 April 1919, a peaceful gathering of thousands of people was held at Jallianwala Bagh in Amritsar on the occasion of Baisakhi to protest against the arrest of national leaders. General Reginald Dyer ordered his troops to open fire without warning on the unarmed crowd. The only exit was blocked and hundreds were killed. This brutal massacre deeply shocked the entire nation and turned Mahatma Gandhi completely against British rule.

****2. Programme of the Non-Cooperation Movement****

The Non-Cooperation Movement was launched by Gandhi in 1920 and officially adopted by the Congress at its Nagpur session (1920). The programme included: Boycott of government schools, colleges, and law courts. Boycott of foreign goods and promotion of Swadeshi. Surrender of titles and honorary offices given by the British. Refusal to attend official functions and government durbars. Promoting khadi (handspun cloth) by using the charkha. Non-payment of taxes in a later stage was also planned.

****3. Suspension of the Movement (The Chauri Chaura Incident)****

On 5 February 1922, at Chauri Chaura in the Gorakhpur district of Uttar Pradesh, a peaceful procession of protesters turned violent. The angry mob set fire to a police station, killing 22 policemen. Gandhi was deeply disturbed by this violence and immediately suspended the Non-Cooperation Movement on 12 February 1922. He believed that the masses were not yet ready for non-violent struggle.

****4. Impact (Significance) of the Movement****

It was the first truly mass-based national movement. The movement brought urban and rural populations, Hindus and Muslims, into the freedom struggle. It demonstrated the power of

non-violent Satyagraha. The British government felt the challenge of a united national awakening. The movement also led to the imprisonment of many leaders, including Motilal Nehru and Jawaharlal Nehru.

****IMPORTANT QUESTIONS: MAHATMA GANDHI AND THE NATIONAL MOVEMENT (NON-COOPERATION MOVEMENT)****

****Q1.**** What were the three main causes that led to the launch of the Non-Cooperation Movement? Explain each briefly.

****Q2.**** What was the Rowlatt Act? Why was it called the "Black Act"?

****Q3.**** Describe the Jallianwala Bagh Massacre and its impact on the Indian national movement.

****Q4.**** What was the Khilafat Movement? How did Gandhi use it to unite Hindus and Muslims?

****Q5.**** State the main programmes of the Non-Cooperation Movement.

****Q6.**** Why did Mahatma Gandhi suspend the Non-Cooperation Movement? Explain the Chauri Chaura incident.

****Q7.**** What was the significance of the Non-Cooperation Movement in India's freedom struggle?

****Q8.**** At which session was the Non-Cooperation Movement officially adopted by the Congress?

****CHAPTER 5: CIVIL DISOBEDIENCE MOVEMENT****

(This section is a continuation of the Gandhian Mass Movements included under your linked video for Non-Cooperation Movement.)

****YouTube Lecture:**** <https://youtu.be/rHQkh80MZfk?si=aOi1WFXd71DQsPw1>

****1. Causes of the Civil Disobedience Movement (1930)****

****A. The Simon Commission (1927)****

The British government appointed the Simon Commission in 1927 to review the working of the Government of India Act 1919. The Commission consisted entirely of British members; no

Indian was included. The Congress and the Muslim League both decided to boycott the Commission. Wherever the Commission went, it was greeted with black flags and the slogan "Simon Go Back!". Lala Lajpat Rai was injured in a police lathi charge during a protest against the Commission at Lahore and later died.

****B. Declaration of Poorna Swaraj (1929)****

The Lahore session of the Indian National Congress (December 1929), under the presidentship of Jawaharlal Nehru, declared Poorna Swaraj (Complete Independence) as the goal of the Indian people. On 26 January 1930, the first Independence Day was celebrated with the unfurling of the tricolour flag. The pledge of Poorna Swaraj was taken by millions across the country.

****C. The Dandi March (1930)****

Gandhi launched the Civil Disobedience Movement by marching from Sabarmati Ashram in Ahmedabad to the coastal village of Dandi (about 385 km away) with 78 trusted followers. The march began on 12 March 1930 and reached Dandi on 6 April 1930. At Dandi, Gandhi broke the salt law by picking up a handful of salt from the seashore, symbolically challenging the unjust British monopoly on salt manufacturing and sale. This act sparked the nationwide Civil Disobedience Movement.

****2. Programme of the Civil Disobedience Movement****

The programme included the violation of the salt law everywhere in India, boycott of British goods and institutions, refusal to pay taxes, picketing of liquor shops and foreign cloth shops, and the manufacture of salt illegally. Lakhs of Indians, including women, participated.

****3. The Gandhi-Irwin Pact and the Second Round Table Conference****

The Gandhi-Irwin Pact was signed on 5 March 1931 between Mahatma Gandhi and the Viceroy Lord Irwin. Gandhi agreed to suspend the Civil Disobedience Movement and participate in the Second Round Table Conference (1931) in London. The British agreed to release all political prisoners not involved in violence.

However, the Second Round Table Conference failed because the British refused to concede the demand for Indian independence. Gandhi returned to India, and the Civil Disobedience Movement was renewed.

****4. Impact of the Movement****

The movement deepened political consciousness among the masses. It brought women out of their homes in large numbers to participate in the freedom struggle. It gave a strong message to the British that Indians were determined to attain freedom.

****IMPORTANT QUESTIONS: CIVIL DISOBEDIENCE MOVEMENT****

****Q1.**** What was the Simon Commission? Why was it boycotted by Indians?

****Q2.**** Explain the significance of the Lahore Session of the Congress (1929).

****Q3.**** Describe the Dandi March and its significance in the Indian national movement.

****Q4.**** What were the main programmes of the Civil Disobedience Movement?

****Q5.**** What was the Gandhi-Irwin Pact? Why did Gandhi agree to participate in the Second Round Table Conference?

****Q6.**** Why did the Civil Disobedience Movement get renewed after the Second Round Table Conference?

****Q7.**** What was the impact of the Civil Disobedience Movement on the Indian masses?

****CHAPTER 6: FORWARD BLOC AND INDIAN NATIONAL ARMY (INA)****

****YouTube Lecture:**** <https://youtu.be/Drw6s-hqFgM?si=5rIH5jBn4-i6eRLL>

****1. Forward Bloc****

The Forward Bloc was founded by Subhas Chandra Bose on 3 May 1939, shortly after he resigned from the Presidentship of the Indian National Congress due to differences with the Gandhian leadership.

****Objectives of the Forward Bloc:****

To achieve complete independence for India through any means, including revolutionary struggle.

To unite all anti-imperialist forces and the left-wing elements within the Congress and outside.

To fight against British imperialism in India and support movements against other colonial powers worldwide.

To reorganise and mobilise the youth and peasants for the struggle.

****2. Indian National Army (INA)****

****Founder:**** The Indian National Army was originally formed by Captain Mohan Singh in Singapore in 1942 with the help of the Japanese. However, it was later reorganised and revived by Subhas Chandra Bose in Singapore on 5 July 1943, where he gave the famous call "Give me blood, and I will give you freedom!".

****Objectives of the INA:****

To liberate India from British rule by military means.

To establish a provisional government of Free India (Azad Hind Government), which Bose formed on 21 October 1943 in Singapore.

To march towards Delhi with the Japanese support from the east.

The INA adopted the slogan "Delhi Chalo" and "Jai Hind". The Indian flag was hoisted on Indian soil in Manipur by the INA in 1944. However, following the defeat of Japan in the Second World War, the INA had to surrender.

****3. Contribution of Subhas Chandra Bose****

Subhas Chandra Bose, popularly known as "Netaji", was a charismatic leader who inspired the youth and the masses. He became the President of the Indian National Congress in 1938 and was re-elected in 1939. He believed that armed struggle was necessary to achieve complete independence. After his differences with Gandhi, he formed the Forward Bloc. His great contribution was leading the INA from Singapore and setting up the Azad Hind government. The famous trials of INA officers at the Red Fort in Delhi created a wave of nationalist enthusiasm across India, forcing the British government to realise that their Indian army could no longer be relied upon to suppress the freedom struggle. It is widely believed that the INA's actions contributed significantly to the British decision to leave India.

****IMPORTANT QUESTIONS: FORWARD BLOC AND INDIAN NATIONAL ARMY (INA)****

****Q1.**** Who founded the Forward Bloc and when? State any two objectives of the Forward Bloc.

****Q2.**** Who was the founder of the original INA? Who revived it and gave it the name "Azad Hind Fauj"?

****Q3.**** State the objectives of the Indian National Army (INA).

****Q4.**** What was the contribution of Subhas Chandra Bose to the Indian freedom struggle?

****Q5.**** Give the meanings of the slogans: (a) "Delhi Chalo", (b) "Jai Hind", (c) "Give me blood, and I will give you freedom!"

****Q6.**** What was the Azad Hind Government? Where and when was it formed?

****Q7.**** Why were the INA trials at the Red Fort significant in the history of the Indian national movement?

****CHAPTER 7: INDEPENDENCE AND PARTITION OF INDIA****

****YouTube Lecture:**** <https://youtu.be/u6sUQwQtqsg?si=XaMSgt0Io3NvVAfM>

****1. The Cabinet Mission Plan (1946)****

The Cabinet Mission was sent by the British Government in March 1946, consisting of three Cabinet ministers: Lord Pethick-Lawrence, Sir Stafford Cripps, and A.V. Alexander.

****Main Clauses (Proposals):****

India would be a federal union consisting of British Indian provinces and princely states.

The Union would control only three subjects: Defence, Foreign Affairs, and Communications.

All other subjects would be under the control of the provinces.

The provinces would be divided into three groups: Group A (Hindu majority provinces), Group B (Muslim majority provinces in the northwest), and Group C (Muslim majority provinces in the northeast).

Each province could opt out of a group after the first general elections.

An Interim Government of Indians was to be formed at the centre.

****2. The Mountbatten Plan (1947)****

Lord Louis Mountbatten became the last Viceroy of India in March 1947. He presented a plan on 3 June 1947, also known as the "June 3rd Plan".

****Main Clauses:****

India would be divided into two independent dominions: India and Pakistan.

The Legislative Assembly of each province (Punjab and Bengal) would decide whether the province was to be divided or not. Both decided in favour of partition.

The Princely States were free to join either India or Pakistan or remain independent.

The British government would transfer power on a given date. The date of transfer of power was advanced to 15 August 1947.

The Mountbatten Plan was accepted by the Congress and the Muslim League. It led to the framing of the Indian Independence Act of 1947.

****3. The Indian Independence Act of 1947 (Clauses)****

The Indian Independence Act was passed by the British Parliament on 18 July 1947.

****Clauses:****

Two independent dominions, India and Pakistan, would be created on 15 August 1947.

The British suzerainty over the princely states would end. They could choose to join either India or Pakistan.

Both dominions would have their own Constituent Assemblies to frame their constitutions.

The office of the Secretary of State for India would be abolished.

Lord Mountbatten would become the first Governor-General of the Dominion of India, and Muhammad Ali Jinnah would become the first Governor-General of the Dominion of Pakistan.

Until the constitution was framed, the Government of India Act 1935 would be the governing act.

****IMPORTANT QUESTIONS: INDEPENDENCE AND PARTITION OF INDIA****

****Q1.**** What was the Cabinet Mission Plan? State any three of its main clauses.

****Q2.**** How did the Cabinet Mission propose to divide the provinces into groups?

****Q3.**** State any three clauses of the Mountbatten Plan.

****Q4.**** Why did the Congress and the Muslim League accept the Mountbatten Plan?

****Q5.**** State the important clauses of the Indian Independence Act of 1947.

****Q6.**** Who became the first Governor-General of independent India?

****Q7.**** How did the Indian Independence Act affect the princely states?

****Q8.**** What was the significance of 3 June 1947 in the history of India?

****CHAPTER 8: THE FIRST WORLD WAR****

****YouTube Lecture:**** <https://youtu.be/ltc4-ABipWY?si=MdDrG2IHkJYLyNaO>

****1. Causes of the First World War (1914-1918)****

****A. Nationalism and Imperialism****

Nationalism in Europe was intense and aggressive. Each nation considered itself superior and wanted to dominate others. Imperialist rivalry among European powers for colonies in Africa and Asia created tension. Britain, France, Germany, and Italy competed to acquire colonies for raw materials and markets. Germany challenged British naval supremacy, which created bitterness.

****B. Armament Race (Militarism)****

European countries engaged in a massive arms race. Germany and Britain competed to build greater naval strength. All major powers increased their armies and weapons. Military planning played a major role in the policies of the governments. Europe had become an armed camp by 1914, awaiting a spark to explode.

****C. Division of Europe into Hostile Camps****

Europe was divided into two major alliances. The Triple Alliance (1882) consisted of Germany, Austria-Hungary, and Italy. The Triple Entente (1907) consisted of Britain, France, and Russia. These alliances were intended to keep peace through a balance of power, but instead, they made any local conflict likely to become a major war.

****D. The Immediate Cause: The Sarajevo Crisis****

On 28 June 1914, Archduke Francis Ferdinand, the heir to the throne of Austria-Hungary, was assassinated in Sarajevo, the capital of Bosnia, by a Serbian nationalist. Austria-Hungary served an ultimatum on Serbia and declared war on 28 July 1914. Russia supported Serbia. Germany supported Austria-Hungary. The alliance system dragged all the major powers into the war, which soon became a world war.

****2. Results of the First World War****

****A. Treaty of Versailles (1919)****

The Treaty of Versailles was signed between the victorious Allied powers and defeated Germany. The terms were harsh. Germany had to cede territory, including Alsace-Lorraine, to France. Its army was reduced, and it was not allowed to have an air force or submarines. Germany was forced to pay a huge war indemnity. This humiliation created deep resentment among Germans and was one of the causes of the rise of Hitler later.

****B. Formation of the League of Nations****

The League of Nations was established in January 1920 as part of the Treaty of Versailles on the initiative of the American President Woodrow Wilson. Its headquarters were in Geneva, Switzerland.

****Objectives of the League of Nations:****

- To maintain international peace and prevent future wars.
- To promote international cooperation and settle disputes through negotiation.
- To improve social and economic conditions worldwide.
- To ensure disarmament by reducing armaments.

****IMPORTANT QUESTIONS: THE FIRST WORLD WAR****

****Q1.**** Explain how aggressive nationalism and imperialism contributed to the outbreak of the First World War.

****Q2.**** What was the armament race? How did it cause the First World War?

****Q3.**** Name the two major alliances that divided Europe before the First World War. Name the member nations of each.

****Q4.**** What was the immediate cause of the First World War? Explain the Sarajevo Crisis.

****Q5.**** Describe any three terms of the Treaty of Versailles.

****Q6.**** When and where was the League of Nations established? State its objectives.

****Q7.**** Why was Germany dissatisfied with the Treaty of Versailles?

****Q8.**** Who proposed the idea of the League of Nations?

****CHAPTER 9: RISE OF DICTATORSHIPS — FASCISM AND NAZISM****

****YouTube Lecture:**** https://youtu.be/4WCRGTjCYI0?si=8vKU4M_F1wWs_IVb

****1. Rise of Fascism in Italy****

Fascism was a political ideology that believed in the absolute supremacy of the state and the unquestioning obedience of the people to its leader. Benito Mussolini founded the Fascist Party in Italy in 1919.

****Causes for the Rise of Fascism in Italy:****

Dissatisfaction with the Treaty of Versailles: Italy joined the war on the side of the Allies expecting territorial gains, but it did not get what was promised.

Economic crisis: After the war, Italy faced severe unemployment, inflation, and industrial unrest.

Fear of Communism: The industrial workers and peasants were influenced by the Russian Revolution (1917). The rich and middle classes supported Fascism to crush communism.

Weak government: The democratic government in Italy failed to solve the country's problems. Mussolini promised stability, order, and national glory.

Charismatic leadership of Mussolini: Mussolini was a brilliant orator who promised to make Italy a great power again. His followers (Blackshirts) used violence against opponents. In 1922, Mussolini and his Blackshirts marched on Rome, and the King of Italy invited him to form the government.

****2. Rise of Nazism in Germany****

Nazism (National Socialism) was the extreme form of Fascism led by Adolf Hitler in Germany.

****Causes for the Rise of Nazism in Germany:****

Humiliation of the Treaty of Versailles: The Treaty was deeply resented by Germans. They felt it was unjust and humiliating. Hitler promised to tear up the Treaty.

Economic crisis: The Great Depression (1929) hit Germany very hard. There was massive unemployment and hyperinflation. People lost faith in the democratic Weimar Republic.

Fear of Communism: The industrialists and the middle classes feared the spread of communism and supported the Nazi Party.

Charismatic leadership of Hitler: Hitler was a powerful speaker who ignited the passion of Germans. He promised to restore German honour and make Germany a great power. He used the Nazi Party and its paramilitary force (Brownshirts) to crush all opposition. In 1933, Hitler became the Chancellor of Germany and soon established a totalitarian dictatorship.

****3. Similarities Between Fascism and Nazism****

Both were totalitarian ideologies that demanded complete obedience to the leader and the state. Both believed in aggressive nationalism and expansionism. Both were opposed to democracy and communism. Both used violence and terror to suppress opposition. Both propagated the supremacy of their own race and believed in the leadership of one supreme leader (Mussolini as Il Duce, Hitler as Der Fuhrer).

****IMPORTANT QUESTIONS: RISE OF DICTATORSHIPS — FASCISM AND NAZISM****

****Q1.**** What is meant by Fascism? Name its founder.

****Q2.**** Explain the causes that led to the rise of Fascism in Italy.

****Q3.**** Why was Italy dissatisfied with the Treaty of Versailles?

****Q4.**** Explain the causes that led to the rise of Nazism in Germany.

****Q5.**** How did the Great Depression of 1929 help in the rise of Hitler and the Nazi Party?

****Q6.**** State any three similarities between the ideologies of Fascism and Nazism.

****Q7.**** What was the "March on Rome"? Who led it and what was its result?

****Q8.**** What promise of Hitler regarding the Treaty of Versailles attracted Germans to Nazism?

****CHAPTER 10: THE SECOND WORLD WAR****

****YouTube Lecture:**** <https://youtu.be/zLDgH9cU0ak?si=vAyF83KfDryAjwF5>

****1. Causes of the Second World War (1939-1945)****

****A. Dissatisfaction with the Treaty of Versailles****

Germany was humiliated by the harsh and unjust terms of the Treaty of Versailles. It lost its territory, its army was reduced, and it was forced to pay a huge war indemnity. The desire for revenge and to restore national honour was a major cause of the rise of Hitler and the Second World War.

****B. Rise of Fascism and Nazism****

The aggressive and expansionist policies of Mussolini (Italy) and Hitler (Germany) led to international tensions. Hitler reoccupied the Rhineland, annexed Austria, and demanded the Sudetenland from Czechoslovakia. These actions went unchecked by the Western powers.

****C. Policy of Appeasement****

Britain and France followed a policy of appeasement, meaning they gave in to Hitler's demands to avoid another war. The Munich Pact (1938) allowed Germany to take over the Sudetenland. Appeasement only encouraged Hitler to make more aggressive demands.

****D. Japanese Invasion of China****

Japan had imperialist ambitions in Asia. In 1931, Japan attacked Manchuria, and in 1937, it launched a full-scale invasion of China. This created tensions with the Western powers.

****E. Failure of the League of Nations****

The League of Nations failed to prevent aggression by Germany, Italy, and Japan. It had no armed force of its own to enforce its decisions. Major powers like the USA were not members, and the League could not act effectively to stop violations of international peace.

****F. Hitler's Invasion of Poland (Immediate Cause)****

On 1 September 1939, Germany invaded Poland. Britain and France had given a guarantee to Poland's security. On 3 September 1939, Britain and France declared war on Germany, marking the beginning of the Second World War.

****2. Important Events of the War****

****Attack on Pearl Harbour (December 7, 1941):**** Japan launched a surprise attack on the US naval base at Pearl Harbour in Hawaii. This brought the United States into the Second World War on the side of the Allies.

****Bombing of Hiroshima and Nagasaki (August 6 and 9, 1945):**** To force Japan to surrender, the United States dropped atomic bombs on the Japanese cities of Hiroshima and Nagasaki. The destruction was unprecedented. Japan surrendered on 2 September 1945, ending the Second World War.

****3. Consequences of the Second World War****

****Defeat of the Axis Powers:**** Germany, Italy, and Japan (the Axis Powers) were completely defeated.

****Formation of the United Nations:**** The United Nations (UN) was established on 24 October 1945 to maintain international peace and prevent future wars, replacing the failed League of Nations.

****The Cold War:**** After the war, the world was divided into two power blocs led by the USA and the USSR. This ideological rivalry between communism and capitalism without an actual direct war is known as the Cold War.

****NATO (North Atlantic Treaty Organization):**** Military alliance led by the USA (Western bloc).

****Warsaw Pact:**** Military alliance led by the USSR (Eastern bloc).

The Cold War was characterised by an arms race, proxy wars, and ideological propaganda.

****IMPORTANT QUESTIONS: THE SECOND WORLD WAR****

****Q1.**** Explain any three causes that led to the Second World War.

****Q2.**** What was the policy of appeasement? How did it contribute to the outbreak of the Second World War?

****Q3.**** Why did the League of Nations fail to prevent the Second World War?

****Q4.**** What was the immediate cause of the Second World War?

****Q5.**** Explain the significance of the attack on Pearl Harbour and the bombing of Hiroshima and Nagasaki in the course of the War.

****Q6.**** State any three consequences of the Second World War.

****Q7.**** What is meant by the Cold War? Name the two military blocs formed during the Cold War.

****Q8.**** When was the United Nations formed and what was its main objective?

****CHAPTER 11: THE UNION LEGISLATURE (PARLIAMENT)****

****YouTube Lecture:**** https://youtu.be/Hv74pZUXxn0?si=f_XmjHWGKsydcPat

****1. Meaning of the Federal Setup in India****

India has a federal system of government. This means that power is divided between the central government and the state governments by the Constitution. Both levels of government have their own separate jurisdictions and derive their authority from the Constitution.

****2. Lok Sabha (House of the People)****

****Term:**** The normal term is 5 years from the date of its first meeting. During a national emergency, the term can be extended by Parliament for one year at a time.

****Composition:**** The maximum strength is 552 members. Up to 530 members represent the states. Up to 20 members represent the Union Territories. Up to 2 Anglo-Indian members can be nominated by the President (this provision has been removed by the 104th Amendment). Members are directly elected by the people on the basis of Universal Adult Franchise.

****Qualifications for Membership:**** Must be a citizen of India. Must be at least 25 years of age. Must possess any other qualification as prescribed by Parliament. Must not hold any office of profit under the government.

****Parliamentary Procedures:****

****Sessions:**** Parliament has three sessions each year: Budget Session, Monsoon Session, and Winter Session.

****Quorum:**** The minimum number of members required to be present before a meeting of the House can begin is one-tenth of the total membership.

****Question Hour:**** The first hour of a sitting in Parliament is set aside for asking and answering questions from the government.

****Types of Questions:****

Starred Question: Oral answers are given on the floor of the House. Supplementary questions can be asked. Marked with a star (*).

Unstarred Question: Written answers are provided. No supplementary questions. Marked with "U".

Short Notice Question: A question that can be asked with less than the usual notice period (10 days) on an urgent matter.

****Zero Hour:**** The time immediately after the Question Hour when members can raise urgent matters without any prior notice. It starts around 12 noon, hence the name.

****Adjournment Motion:**** A motion moved to draw the attention of the House to a definite matter of urgent public importance. If passed, it means the House does not have confidence in the government.

****No-Confidence Motion:**** A motion moved by the opposition stating that the House no longer has confidence in the Council of Ministers. If passed, the Council of Ministers must resign.

****Anti-Defection Law:**** Under this law, a member of Parliament or State Legislature is disqualified if he/she voluntarily gives up the membership of the political party on whose ticket he/she was elected, or if he/she votes or abstains from voting in the House contrary to the direction of the party.

****Passing of Bills:****

Ordinary Bills: Can be introduced in either House of Parliament (except Money Bills). Must be passed by both Houses by a simple majority. Rajya Sabha can delay an Ordinary Bill for a maximum of 6 months.

Money Bills: Can only be introduced in the Lok Sabha. After the Lok Sabha passes the Bill, it is transmitted to the Rajya Sabha. Rajya Sabha can only make recommendations within 14 days. The Lok Sabha may or may not accept them.

****The Speaker:**** Elected by the members of the Lok Sabha from among themselves.
Functions: Presides over the sittings of the Lok Sabha. Maintains discipline and decorum in the House. Decides whether a Bill is a Money Bill or not. Decides on points of order. Can cast a deciding vote in case of a tie.

****3. Rajya Sabha (Council of States)****

****Composition:**** Maximum strength is 250 members. 238 members represent States and Union Territories (elected indirectly by the elected members of Legislative Assemblies). 12 members are nominated by the President for their special knowledge or practical experience in literature, science, art, and social service.

****Qualifications for Membership:**** Must be a citizen of India. Must be at least 30 years of age.

****Election:**** Rajya Sabha is a permanent house and is not subject to dissolution. One-third of its members retire every two years. Members serve a 6-year term.

****Presiding Officer:**** The Vice-President of India is the ex-officio Chairman of the Rajya Sabha.

****4. Powers and Functions of the Union Parliament****

****Legislative Powers:**** Makes laws on subjects in the Union List and Concurrent List.

****Financial Powers:**** Approves the budget. No tax can be levied or money spent without Parliament's approval.

****Judicial Powers:**** Can remove the President, Vice-President, and judges of the Supreme Court and High Courts through impeachment.

****Electoral Powers:**** Participates in the election of the President and Vice-President.

****Amendment of the Constitution:**** Parliament can amend the Constitution. For certain amendments, ratification by half the State Legislatures is needed.

****Control over Executive:**** Parliament keeps a check on the Council of Ministers through Question Hour, Adjournment Motion, No-Confidence Motion, etc.

****5. Exclusive Powers of the Two Houses****

****Lok Sabha:**** Money Bills can only be introduced in the Lok Sabha. The Council of Ministers is collectively responsible only to the Lok Sabha. A No-Confidence Motion can only be moved in the Lok Sabha.

****Rajya Sabha:**** Can authorise Parliament to legislate on a State subject (Article 249). Can create All India Services.

****IMPORTANT QUESTIONS: THE UNION LEGISLATURE (PARLIAMENT)****

****Q1.**** What is meant by a federal setup? State the composition of the Lok Sabha.

****Q2.**** What is Quorum? Explain the different types of questions asked during Question Hour in the Lok Sabha.

****Q3.**** Distinguish between a starred question and an unstarred question.

****Q4.**** What is the Zero Hour? What is an Adjournment Motion?

****Q5.**** Differentiate between a Money Bill and an Ordinary Bill in terms of introduction and passing.

****Q6.**** Explain the Anti-Defection Law.

****Q7.**** How is the Speaker of the Lok Sabha elected? State any three functions of the Speaker.

****Q8.**** How does the Rajya Sabha differ from the Lok Sabha in its composition? Why is Rajya Sabha called a permanent house?

****Q9.**** State any three powers and functions of the Union Parliament.

****Q10.**** State any two exclusive powers of the Lok Sabha and any two exclusive powers of the Rajya Sabha.

****CHAPTER 12: THE UNION EXECUTIVE – PRESIDENT AND VICE PRESIDENT****

****YouTube Lecture:**** <https://youtu.be/pfTlqBJg5IM?si=Ze3lUyFgWT0Uyvkf0>

****1. The President of India****

****A. Qualifications for Election****

Must be a citizen of India.

Must have completed 35 years of age.

Must be qualified to be elected as a member of the Lok Sabha.

Must not hold any office of profit under the Government of India or any State Government.

****B. Composition of the Electoral College****

The President is elected by an Electoral College consisting of:

The elected members of both Houses of Parliament (Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha).

The elected members of the Legislative Assemblies of all States and Union Territories of Delhi and Puducherry.

Nominated members do not vote.

****C. Reason for Indirect Election****

The President has vast powers, and direct election would be very expensive and time-consuming. Also, a directly elected President might become a rival power centre to the Prime Minister. In a parliamentary system, the President is the nominal head, and direct election is considered unnecessary.

****D. Term of Office****

The President holds office for a term of 5 years from the date on which he/she enters office. The President is eligible for re-election.

****E. Impeachment of the President****

The President can be impeached (removed from office) only for "violation of the Constitution". The resolution can be introduced in either House of Parliament. A 14-day notice must be given to the President. The resolution must be passed by a two-thirds majority of the total membership of that House. It is then sent to the other House, which investigates the charges. If the other House also passes it by a two-thirds majority, the President stands removed.

****F. Powers of the President****

****Executive Powers:**** All executive actions are taken in the name of the President. The President appoints the Prime Minister, other Ministers, Governors, Judges of Supreme Court and High Courts, the Attorney General, the Chief Election Commissioner, and other officials.

****Legislative Powers:**** The President summons and prorogues Parliament. Can dissolve the Lok Sabha. No Bill can become a law without the President's assent. The President nominates 12 members to the Rajya Sabha.

****Financial Powers:**** The Annual Budget is presented in Parliament on behalf of the President. No Money Bill can be introduced in Parliament without the prior recommendation of the President.

****Judicial Powers:**** The President has the power to grant pardon, reprieve, respite, or commutation of punishment.

****Discretionary Powers:**** When no single party gets a clear majority, the President may invite a leader who is most likely to prove a majority to form the government.

****Emergency Powers:**** The President can declare three types of emergencies:

National Emergency (Article 352): On grounds of war, external aggression, or armed rebellion. Two effects: Fundamental Rights (except Articles 20 and 21) can be suspended. The Union Government can give directions to any State.

State Emergency (President's Rule, Article 356): If the Governor reports that the state administration cannot be carried on according to the Constitution, the President can assume all functions of the state government.

Financial Emergency (Article 360): If the financial stability of India is threatened.

****2. The Vice-President of India****

****A. Qualifications for Election****

Must be a citizen of India.

Must have completed 35 years of age.

Must be qualified to be elected as a member of the Rajya Sabha.

****B. Election and Term****

The Vice-President is elected by an Electoral College consisting of members of both Houses of Parliament. The term is 5 years. The Vice-President can be removed by a resolution passed by a majority of all the then members of the Rajya Sabha and agreed to by the Lok Sabha.

****C. Powers and Functions****

The Vice-President is the ex-officio Chairman of the Rajya Sabha and presides over its sittings. The Vice-President acts as President during the absence of the President, or when the office of the President falls vacant due to death, resignation, or removal, until a new President is elected (maximum period of 6 months).

****IMPORTANT QUESTIONS: THE UNION EXECUTIVE – PRESIDENT AND VICE PRESIDENT****

****Q1.**** State the qualifications required to become the President of India.

****Q2.**** Describe the composition of the Electoral College that elects the President. Why is the President elected indirectly?

****Q3.**** How can the President be impeached?

****Q4.**** Explain the legislative powers of the President of India.

****Q5.**** What are the emergency powers of the President? Name the three types of emergencies and state two effects of a National Emergency.

****Q6.**** What are the discretionary powers of the President?

****Q7.**** State any three differences in the election of the President and the Vice-President.

****Q8.**** How can the Vice-President be removed from office?

****Q9.**** State the qualifications and functions of the Vice-President.

****Q10.**** What is meant by President's Rule (State Emergency)?

****CHAPTER 13: PRIME MINISTER AND COUNCIL OF MINISTERS****

****YouTube Lecture:**** https://youtu.be/CcQYZKoblsM?si=yoVP5_X7Q5E-R2T-

****1. Appointment and Formation****

The President appoints the Prime Minister. The leader of the majority party or coalition in the Lok Sabha is called by the President to form the government. The Prime Minister selects other ministers. On the advice of the Prime Minister, the President then formally appoints other ministers. The Council of Ministers consists of three ranks: Cabinet Ministers, Ministers of State (with or without independent charge), and Deputy Ministers. The Prime Minister and the Council of Ministers are collectively responsible to the Lok Sabha.

****2. Distinction Between the Council of Ministers and the Cabinet****

The Council of Ministers is the entire body of all ranks of ministers. The Cabinet is a smaller and more important body consisting of senior Cabinet Ministers only. The Cabinet is the inner core of the Council of Ministers that takes all major policy decisions. The Cabinet is the real centre of power. The Council of Ministers as a whole rarely meets; the Cabinet meets frequently.

****3. Position and Powers of the Prime Minister****

The Prime Minister is the head of the central government and the real executive. The office of the Prime Minister is the most powerful office in India's parliamentary system.

The Prime Minister recommends to the President the appointment of other ministers and their portfolios.

The Prime Minister presides over Cabinet meetings and decides its agenda.

The Prime Minister is the principal link between the President and the Cabinet.

The Prime Minister is the leader of the Lok Sabha.

The Prime Minister represents the nation at international conferences.

The Prime Minister can recommend the dissolution of the Lok Sabha to the President.

****4. Collective and Individual Responsibility****

****Collective Responsibility:**** The Council of Ministers is collectively responsible to the Lok Sabha. If a No-Confidence Motion is passed against any minister, the entire Council of Ministers must resign. All ministers swim or sink together.

****Individual Responsibility:**** Each minister is individually responsible for the acts of his or her ministry to the President. The ministers hold office during the pleasure of the President, which means the Prime Minister can request any minister to resign.

****5. Functions of the Prime Minister and Council of Ministers****

****Policy Making:**** Formulating and implementing domestic and foreign policies.

****Administrative:**** Coordinating and guiding the work of various ministries.

****Legislative:**** Introducing important Bills in Parliament. Preparing and presenting the budget.

****Financial:**** Determining tax policies and government expenditure.

****Emergency:**** Advising the President on the declaration of emergencies.

****IMPORTANT QUESTIONS: PRIME MINISTER AND COUNCIL OF MINISTERS****

****Q1.**** How is the Prime Minister appointed? Describe the formation of the Council of Ministers.

****Q2.**** Distinguish between the Council of Ministers and the Cabinet.

****Q3.**** Describe the position and powers of the Prime Minister of India.

****Q4.**** Explain the concept of collective responsibility of the Council of Ministers.

****Q5.**** What is meant by the individual responsibility of a minister?

****Q6.**** State any three functions of the Council of Ministers.

****Q7.**** Who presides over the meetings of the Cabinet?

****Q8.**** What happens when a No-Confidence Motion is passed against the Council of Ministers in the Lok Sabha?

****CHAPTER 14: THE UNION JUDICIARY****

****YouTube Lecture:**** <https://youtu.be/CcQYZKoblsM?si=ea200KYTs42Sv8is>

****1. The Supreme Court****

****A. Composition****

The Supreme Court of India consists of the Chief Justice of India and other judges. At present, the maximum number of judges is 34 (including the Chief Justice). The Chief Justice is appointed by the President. Other judges are appointed by the President in consultation with the Chief Justice.

****B. Qualifications of Judges****

Must be a citizen of India.

Must have been a judge of a High Court for at least 5 years, or an advocate of a High Court for at least 10 years, or a distinguished jurist in the opinion of the President.

****C. Independence of the Judiciary from the Executive and Legislature****

The judges of the Supreme Court are appointed by the President and their appointment is not subject to interference by the executive.

The judges have security of tenure. They cannot be removed except by impeachment (by a two-thirds majority of both Houses of Parliament) on grounds of proven misbehaviour or incapacity.

The salaries and allowances of judges are charged on the Consolidated Fund of India and cannot be reduced during their term.

No discussion can take place in Parliament regarding the conduct of a judge in the discharge of his duties.

****D. Jurisdiction and Functions****

****Original Jurisdiction:**** The Supreme Court can hear cases directly (as a court of first instance) between the Government of India and one or more States, or between two or more States. It has exclusive original jurisdiction in cases involving the enforcement of Fundamental Rights and can issue writs (Habeas Corpus, Mandamus, Prohibition, Quo Warranto, Certiorari) for this purpose.

****Appellate Jurisdiction:**** The Supreme Court hears appeals against the decisions of the High Courts in civil, criminal, and constitutional cases.

****Advisory Jurisdiction:**** The President can seek the advice of the Supreme Court on any question of law or fact of public importance. The opinion is not binding.

****Revisory Jurisdiction:**** The Supreme Court can review any law or order passed by any authority and can reverse its own decision.

****Judicial Review:**** The Supreme Court can examine the validity of laws passed by Parliament or State Legislatures. If a law is found in violation of the Constitution, it can be declared null and void (ultra vires).

****Court of Record:**** The judgments of the Supreme Court are recorded and serve as precedents for lower courts. The Supreme Court can punish for contempt of itself.

****2. The High Court****

Every state (or a group of states) has a High Court.

****Composition:**** Each High Court consists of a Chief Justice and other judges as determined by the President. The Chief Justice is appointed by the President in consultation with the Chief Justice of India and the Governor of the state. Other judges are appointed in consultation with the Chief Justice of the High Court.

****Qualifications:**** Must be a citizen of India. Must have held a judicial office in India for at least 10 years, or been an advocate of a High Court for at least 10 years.

****Jurisdiction and Functions:****

****Original Jurisdiction:**** The High Court can hear cases relating to Fundamental Rights, wills, divorce, company law, and admiralty disputes. It can issue writs for the enforcement of Fundamental Rights.

****Appellate Jurisdiction:**** It hears appeals against the decisions of subordinate courts in civil and criminal cases.

****Revisory Jurisdiction:**** It can review the judgements of subordinate courts.

****Judicial Review:**** It can examine the constitutionality of state laws and orders.

****Court of Record:**** Its decisions are recorded and serve as precedents. It can punish for contempt.

****3. Subordinate Courts****

****District Judge's Court:**** The highest civil court in a district. Handles civil cases like property disputes, contract disputes, etc.

****Sessions Court:**** The highest criminal court in a district. Handles criminal cases like murder, theft, etc. The District Judge and the Sessions Judge may be the same person.

****Lok Adalats (People's Courts):**** These are alternative dispute resolution mechanisms. They encourage settlement of disputes through compromise or conciliation. Advantages: Speedy justice, less expensive, reduces the burden on regular courts, and the decision is binding on both parties.

****IMPORTANT QUESTIONS: THE UNION JUDICIARY****

****Q1.**** Explain the composition of the Supreme Court of India. How are the judges appointed?

****Q2.**** State any three qualifications required to become a judge of the Supreme Court.

****Q3.**** Explain any three provisions that ensure the independence of the judiciary.

****Q4.**** Explain the Original Jurisdiction of the Supreme Court.

****Q5.**** What is meant by Judicial Review? Why is the Supreme Court called the guardian of the Constitution?

****Q6.**** What is a Court of Record? What is meant by contempt of court?

****Q7.**** State any three differences between the jurisdiction of the Supreme Court and the High Court.

****Q8.**** Explain the advisory jurisdiction of the Supreme Court.

****Q9.**** Write a short note on Lok Adalats and their advantages.

****Q10.**** Distinguish between the Court of the District Judge and the Sessions Court.
